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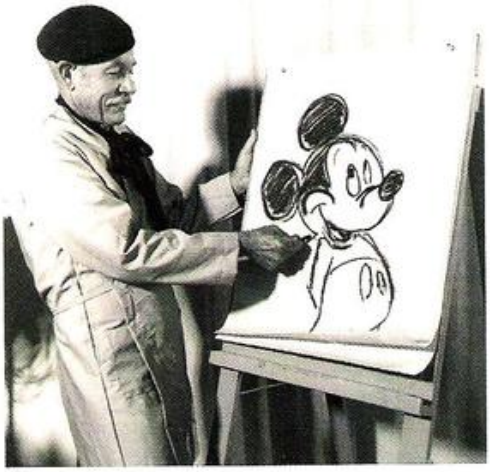
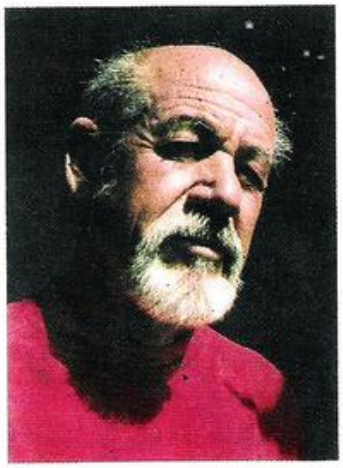
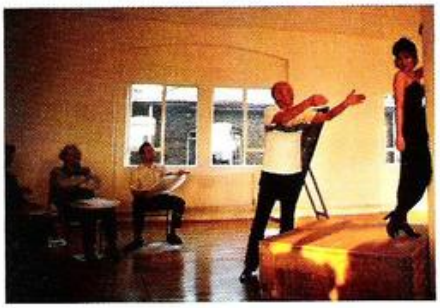






It is management's wish that the "Disney Tradition" be revitalized and maintained. The tradition, as we see it, reflects the desires and aspirations of Walt, who, when alive strove to bring animation to a highly developed art. In attempting to recapture the quality attained in former years, we need not but refer to that letter Walt wrote to Don Graham in 1935. It expresses the needs of the animation artist and the means he felt were necessary to develop and fulfill those needs.

Walt not only encouraged his employees to better themselves by bringing teachers and lecturers to the studio but he demanded constant improvement. We don't have Walt with us today but we do have the great heritage of animation he left, plus the facilities and the talent with which to uphold that heritage and, to risk hopefully sacrilege, improve on it.

Nevertheless, there will be an attempt to reinstate the learning atmosphere that once permeated this studio. There will be various classes, conducted by numerous instructors. There will be suggested reading and film study; discussions on action analysis and its application to our media.

There will be no attempt to return to any particular era of the past, but to incorporate a composite of all the great accomplishments of the past into a future product that we can all be proud of.

Stan Green 2/10/64

# 1

# Innovation

Some of these sketches (preliminaries for paintings, called cartoons) are extremely rough and detailless, but certainly not lacking in expression. They had to tell a whole story in one painting, so a concerted effort had to be made to get the proper gestures. Most of these sketches are in a serious vein, but are nonetheless entertaining.

That is the kind of probing and exploring needed in preliminary drawings for the more final creation or performance. It was necessary for some of those masters to spend months, even years, on a single painting to complete it. An animator's searching and probing resemble those of the master's in many ways, but the animator has to move on immediately. He must do dozens of them in the time it took Rembrandt to prime his canvas.

# 2

## Drawing

Here is a collection of expressive hands from Disney veteran, Milt Kahl.

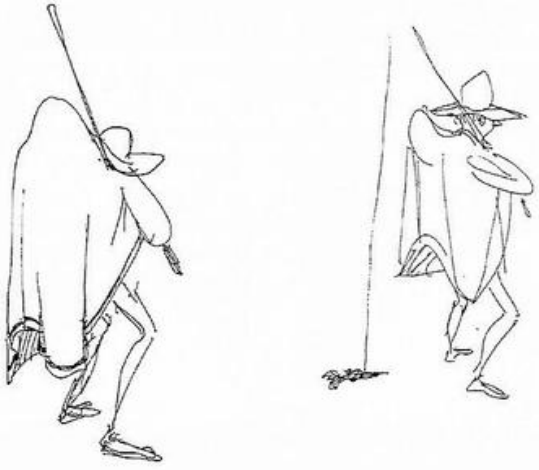
And more from the pages of *Mad* magizine.

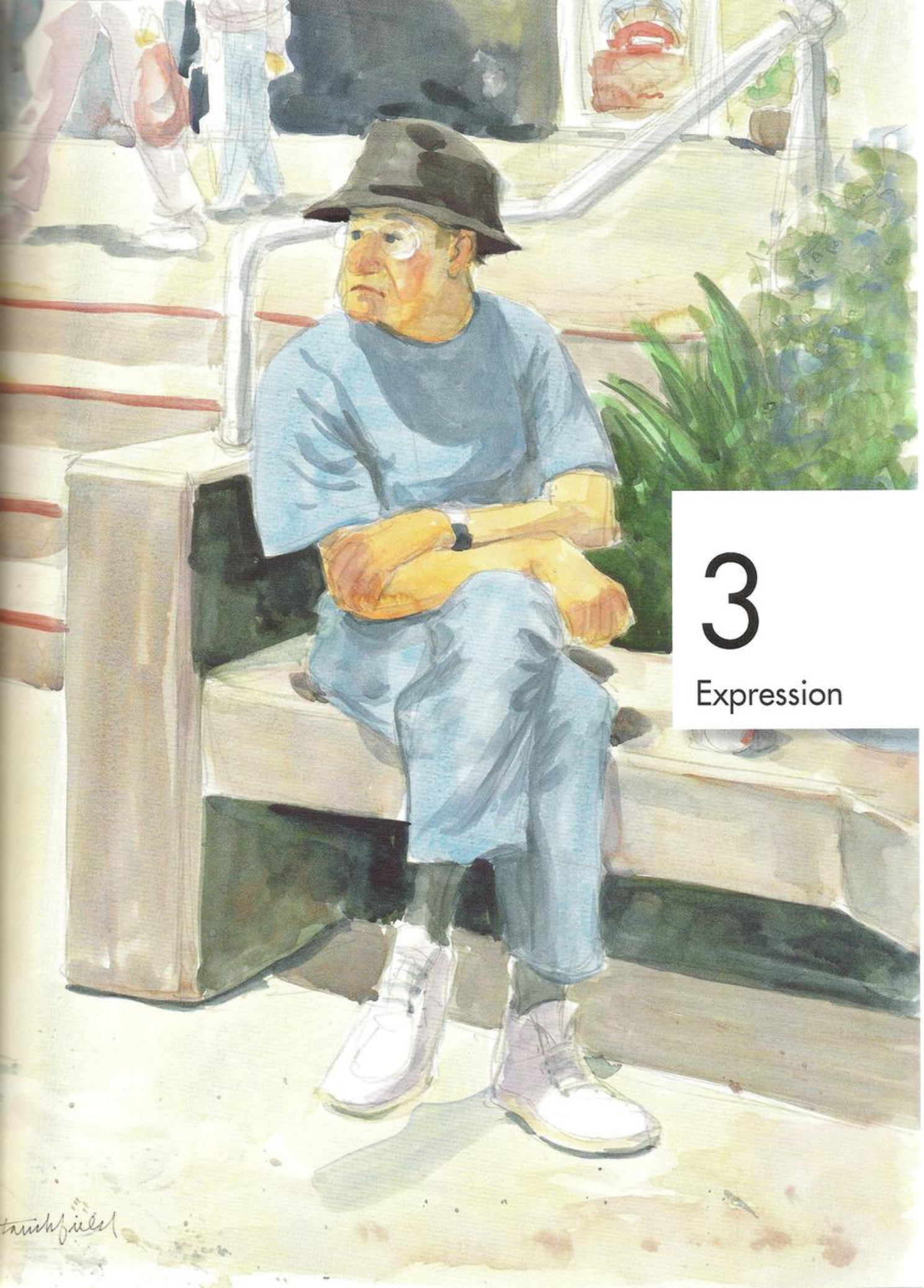
theory, or as someone's private opinion, and try to blend it with your present understanding of drawing. Let it help form a clearer concept — one you can utilize with confidence.

In an article from *American Artist,* October 1990, Barnett is said to have told his students:

> ...forget all hopes for a sure-fire formula. He couldn't teach them tricks. He could only recommend one answer: to see something as a whole, to visualize a subject as a complex of shapes, rather than as independent elements, (sound familiar?) to seek out the invisible web of line, shape, and form that lies beneath the apparently unconnected set of objects and creates the rhythm that vitalizes and unifies all parts of the image. Barnett felt that once the student could learn to see in this rhythmical, unifying way, "It's likely that (he or she) would not need to study or to learn anymore.
>
> Students found this concept elusive. Barnett wrote that most students, looking at a still life or model, would be deluded by the notion that if they can copy the subject accurately enough they will convey to the viewer the same sensation that they've received. But the truth of the matter is quite different. The essence is, "...elusive and lurks under the casual, superficial experience," he noted. "Volume is not a realistic element but an abstract one. We don't see volume, we sense it; we remember it; we feel it in our bones. We can hardly expect to capture it by looking at individual objects.
>
> Barnett stressed that when we look directly at an object, we miss its relationship to the things around it. (Like drawing a hand or a knee without regarding its relationship to all other parts of the body.) To see a thing well, he advised, "Always see it at the same time as something in another part of the picture (or figure). To paint (or draw) a right hand area, stare at the left. Look at a part of the subject and draw the part required as it is seen out of the corner of the eye. When studying one side of an object, always see the other side. See both ears of a head, both sides of an apple or jug. In a landscape, see the roof, foundation, and the ends of the barn all at once. In a still life, see the front of the table and the background at the same time."

Now if we may return to our own backyard... When I reprint a student's drawing with an accompanying correction, I never use a name, but when printing the outstanding drawings from our classes, I tell who did them. This does not mean I am trying to "sell" the artist. If I print one artist's drawings more often than others, it is only because those drawings fit into my line of thinking. Here is yet another such case. Recently, Richard Oliver modeled for us. He does a lot of poses that are kooky and hard to form a story for. In one pose he stuffed some cloth into the back of a strange looking coat as if he were a humpback. The hump was crooked and just looked like it was something stuffed into a strange looking coat. But Dan Boulos, captured (or created) the essence of this one with quick-witted perception. Here are two versions of the same pose. You can see by the variance in them that *he was not copying, but did them with a generous mixture of imagination and creativity.*





# 3

## Expression

# 48 An Inspirational Journey

In this handout, I have compiled a potpourri of quotations, some of which you may find suitable for clipping out and pinning up. Some of them were taken from art books and some from a book called *Writers on Writing*. Writers are artists, so what they say can be construed to apply to us (drawers), too. Some of the quotes are from *The Power In You,* an inspirational book by Wally "Famous" Amos (the face that launched a thousand chips), to whom I often turn for a mental uplift. I refer to some of them as 1,000-volt jump-starts.

Some have a definite "religious" overtone for which I do not apologize. The word "spirit" has a vital place in everyone's life.

And so you may know exactly who it is that has assembled these aphorisms, maxims, and guides to a happier and brighter future — here I am depicted by the penetrating pen of Mike Gabriel.

I'm taking a once a week class at Hancock College in Santa Maria under the wild tutelage of Robert Burridge. He shared this advice from the artist known as SARK.

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passed on to the herd. This overall reactive motion counters the static base, providing an ingredient without which art does not exist: contrast. The immovable anchor of the ground and rocks compounds the sense of rushing in the horses; whose heads comprise an agitated line, punctuated by angular negative spaces.

"The Ridge Runners" goes beyond simple depiction of movement to a powerful statement of kinetically dynamic forces. Working from knowledge and gut reaction, Hodges delivers doses of contrast in variable strengths that breathe life into this work.

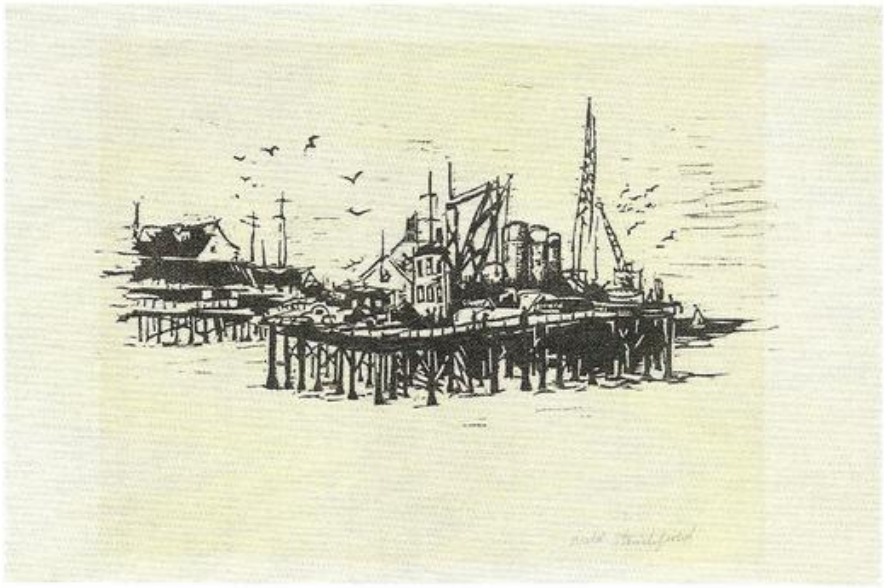
You can easily spot those kinetic forces Hines spoke about. Now for some closer-to-home examples that I have concocted, using drawings from various past handouts. Once you become aware of these kinetic forces, they will appear by the dozens to you. Every drawing, I repeat, every drawing you'll ever make will need them, whether in wild or subtle amounts. Become aware of them, caricature them, and you'll have yourself a memorable, entertaining gesture drawing. Here are the first drawings.

In this example the model is reaching. I include the student's drawing so you can get the feel of caricature and how important your mental concept of the gesture is. My correction drawing (on the right) features the upper body bending forward and the arm swinging down for the reach. Notice the arm is slightly bent. Bending a line (or shape) seems to suggest a move in the direction of the bend. It's a psychological thing, maybe, because we associate it with the bow and arrow.

a drop of liquid,

or pancake batter which moves in all directions as it settles in the pan.

Sometimes in animation, a fast moving object's leading edge will be rounded (bent) with effects training aft.



Those are difficult things to portray in a drawing, are they not? Even descriptive things are not easy:

His dark hawkish face seemed never to have known a smile.
He looked like a hawk with mumps.
A square wall of a forehead with heavy brows for a base.

Each of those descriptions evoked a definite physical attribute — to illustrate them in drawing form would require some rather inspired sketching.

Actually, according to Alan Watts, the proverb goes, "One showing is worth a hundred sayings." In his book *The Way of Zen,* he explains it thus:

> The Chinese written language has a slight advantage over our own, and is perhaps symptomatic of a different way of thinking. It is still linear, still a series of abstractions taken in one at a time. But its written signs are little closer to life than spelled words because they are essentially pictures, and as a Chinese proverb puts it, "One showing is worth a hundred sayings." Compare, for example, the ease of showing someone how to tie a complex knot with the difficulty of telling him how to do it in words alone.

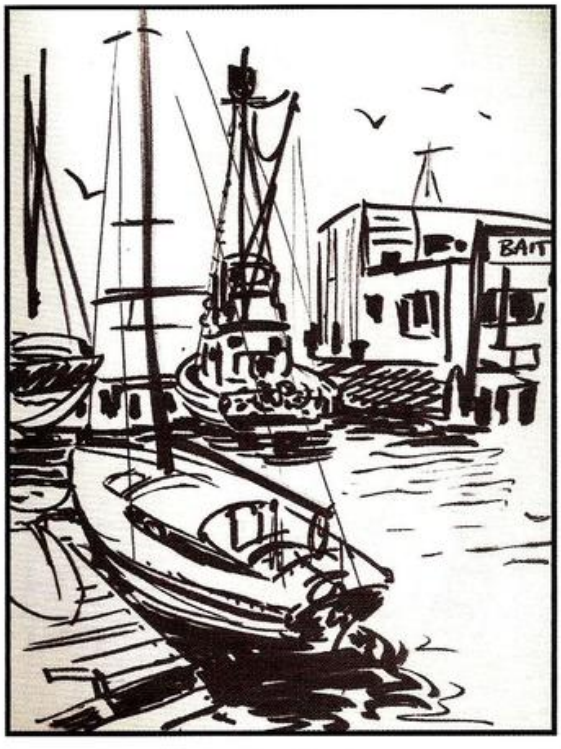
This is not to suggest that we learn to use a series of diagrams to illustrate our meanings, our stories — but that we strive to pantomime our drawings to the point where words are not necessary to grasp their full meaning. Almost as if the sound went dead during one of our pictures and the drawings by themselves would carry the story along.

## SHOW US HOW TO DRAW!

We yearn for the ultimate book of drawing, or the teacher who can, once and for all, show us how to draw, so we can get on with our lives. We study anatomy, vanishing points, and overlap; we study distribution of weight, balance, shape, design, etc., and drawing is still a frustrating experience. We call out in pain and disappointment — our efforts should have reaped a better harvest.

We mediate, searching for mental blocks from the past that keep us from victory. If we could just identify the devils that thwart our progress so we can administer the emancipating blow. Or better yet, if we could somehow form a partnership with the source of all creative energy.

Enjoy these drawings – they are fun and pure entertainment.

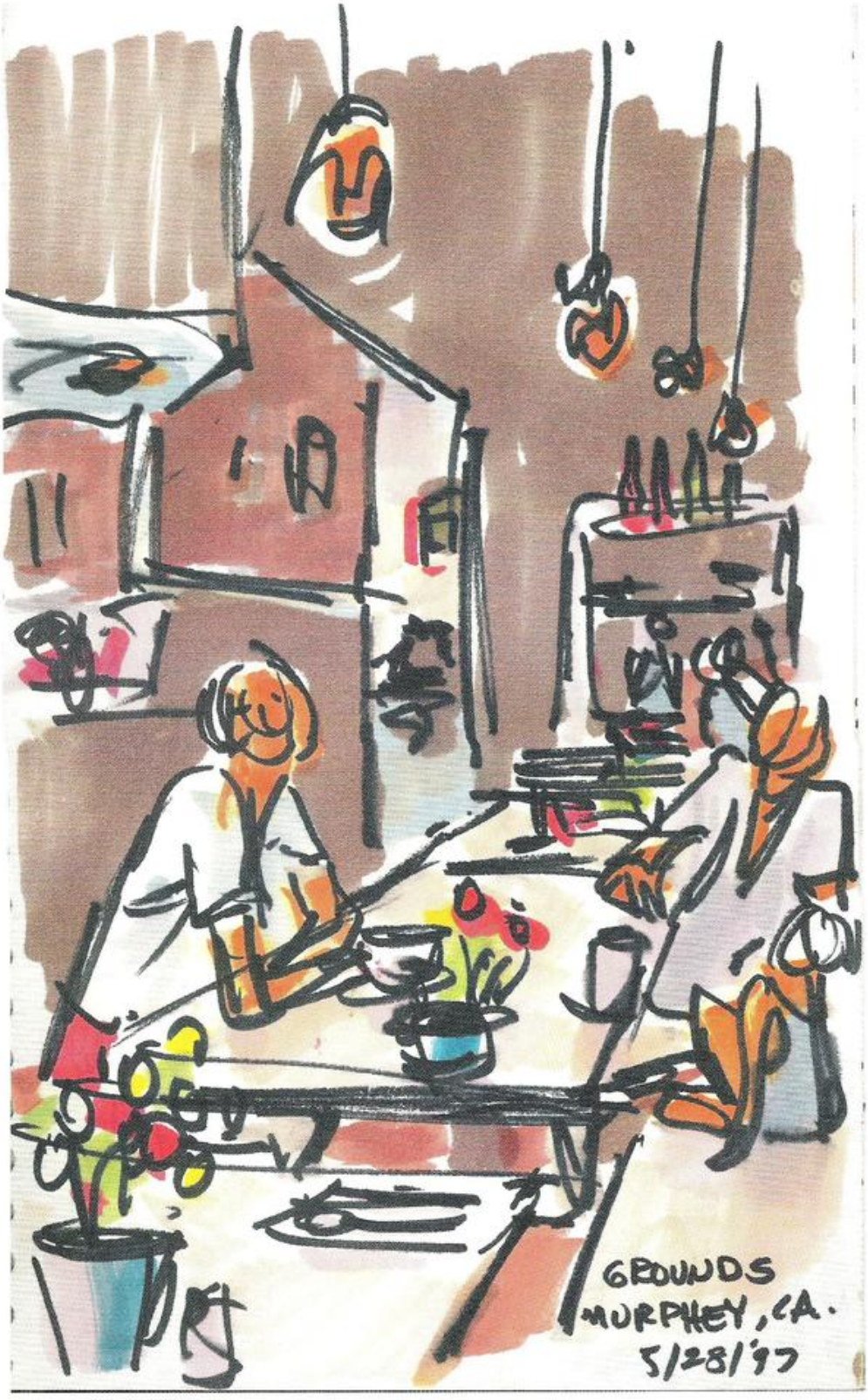



Let's start with the rule of overlap. This is one I am extremely conscious of while drawing. It not only allows one to create the illusion of third dimensional space by drawing one thing in front of another, but it helps establish and control angles, plus is the basis for foreshortened figures. It is also helpful in drawing drapery. There are many ways to represent and use overlap. Let's analyze and expand on it a bit.

1. This is plain overlap. Notice how it creates a sense of space, whereas two circles (or objects) beside each other create a tangent and result in a two dimensional flatness.

2. Here is overlap plus diminished size creating a greater illusion of space.

Here's overlap with diminished size and surface.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THE WALT STANCHFIELD LECTURES: VOLUME TWO

ANIMATION/DRAWING

"Walt was a kind of Mark Twain for us at Disney. He always taught with humor and skill. You learned to see the world through his eyes. I remember him one day encouraging us to leap into our drawings with boldness and confidence, "Don't be afraid to make a mistake. We all have 10,000 bad drawings in us so the sooner you get them out the better!" Sitting in Walt's class was as much a psychology course as it was a drawing class. One couldn't help walk away with your mind and soul a little more open than when you entered."

**– Glen Keane**, Walt Disney Animation Studios

"Walt Stanchfield's classes and writings were little distillations of the man: quirky, strongly stated in a genial voice, and brimming with a lifetime of sharp observations about story telling and graphic communication. Whether he drew with a ball point pen or painted with a brush dipped in his coffee cup, he got to the essence of things and was eager to share what he learned with his eager disciples, myself among them. He was grizzled and he was great and proof that there was more than one Walt at the Disney Studios that could inspire a legion of artists."

**– John Musker**, Walt Disney Animation Studios

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THE WALT STANCHFIELD LECTURES: VOLUME TWO

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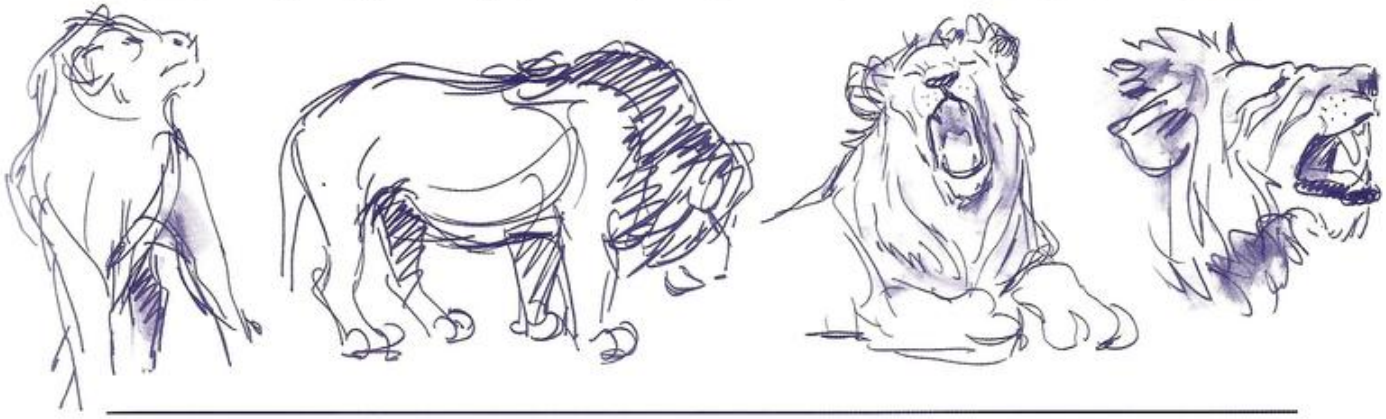

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